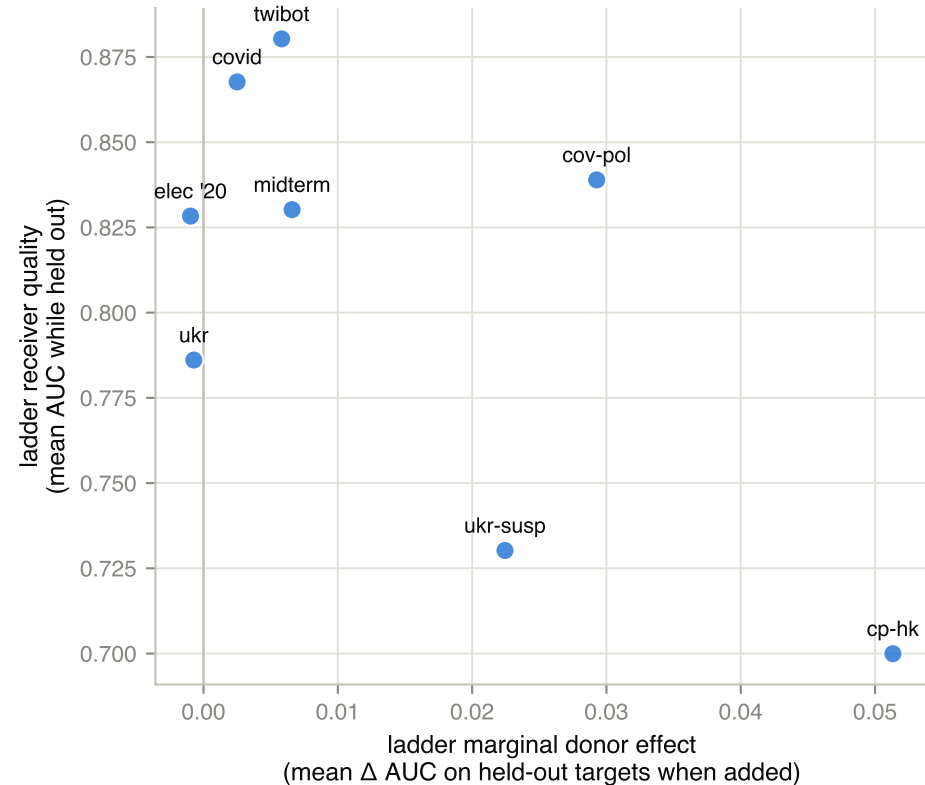


Donor & receiver quality: what the ladder can and cannot measure

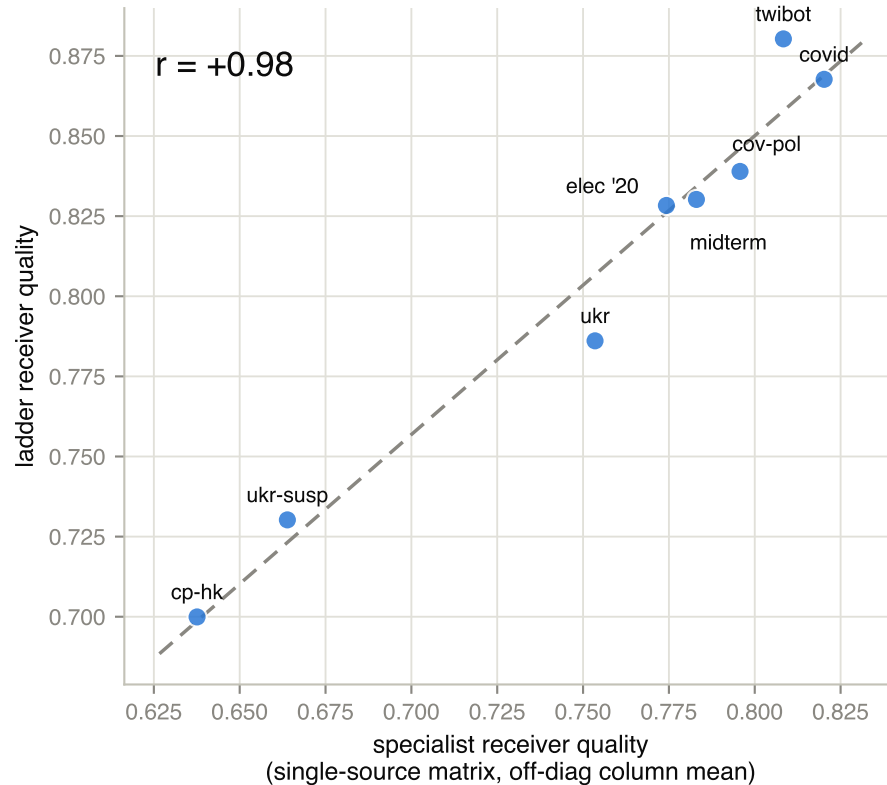
NM 3-shot / 30-way · ladder receiver = mean AUC over the 7–14 cells where the graph is not yet in the merge · ladder donor = mean Δ on held-out targets over the source's 3–12 held-out (target, step) events

specialist qualities = off-diagonal row / column means of the single-source matrix · headroom adjustment = residual of Δ on the target's AUC just before the step (the $r = -0.40$ recovery trend) · inverted raw donor r: weak donors were added when headroom was largest (order C)

the ladder's donor × receiver plane



receiver quality REPLICATES across designs



donor quality does NOT — it is receiver headroom

